

Business Requirements Document

WorkNest — Freelance Marketplace Platform

Prepared: July 1, 2026 | Version 1.0

Document Title	Business Requirements Document (BRD) — WorkNest
Project Name	WorkNest — Freelance Marketplace Platform
Version	1.0
Date	July 1, 2026
Prepared For	Project Stakeholders
Status	Draft

Table of Contents

Table of Contents	2
1. Executive Summary.....	3
2. Business Objectives.....	3
3. Stakeholders / User Roles	3
4. Project Scope	4
4.1 In Scope.....	4
4.2 Out of Scope.....	4
5. Functional Requirements.....	4
FR-1 Authentication & Authorization.....	4
FR-2 User Profiles.....	5
FR-3 Job Marketplace.....	5
FR-4 Proposal Management.....	5
FR-5 Interview Scheduling.....	5
FR-6 Project Workspace	5
FR-8 Project Delivery	6
FR-9 Payment Simulation	6
FR-10 Notifications.....	6
FR-11 Administrator Dashboard	6
6. Non-Functional Requirements.....	6
7. User Flows	7
7.1 Client Flow.....	7
7.2 Freelancer Flow.....	7
7.3 Administrator Flow	8
8. Assumptions & Constraints.....	8
8.1 Assumptions.....	8
8.2 Constraints	8
9. Approval.....	9

1. Executive Summary

WorkNest is a full-stack freelance marketplace web application built on the MERN stack (MongoDB, Express.js, React.js, and Node.js). The platform connects clients with freelancers in a secure, organized environment for managing freelance work from job posting through to project completion.

Clients can post jobs, review freelancer proposals, schedule interviews, hire freelancers, monitor project progress, and approve completed work. Freelancers can create professional profiles, showcase portfolios, apply for jobs, and submit completed projects. The platform also includes a simulated payment process, real-time notifications, and an administrator dashboard for platform oversight.

This document defines the business requirements that WorkNest must satisfy, including business objectives, stakeholder roles, functional and non-functional requirements, user workflows, and the assumptions and constraints governing delivery.

2. Business Objectives

ID	Objective
BO-01	Provide a centralized platform connecting clients and freelancers for end-to-end project management.
BO-02	Simplify and streamline the hiring and project management workflow.
BO-03	Improve platform trust through a simulated, transparent payment process.
BO-04	Enable organized tracking of project progress via milestones and status updates.
BO-05	Give freelancers the tools to showcase skills, experience, and portfolios.
BO-06	Equip administrators with the tools to monitor users and moderate platform activity.
BO-07	Demonstrate production-ready MERN stack development practices suitable for real-world applications.

3. Stakeholders / User Roles

WorkNest supports three primary user roles, each with distinct responsibilities and system permissions.

Role	Responsibilities
Client	Hires freelancers and manages projects: register/login, manage profile, post and manage jobs, review proposals, schedule interviews, hire freelancers, manage project workspace, track milestones, approve completed work, request revisions, release simulated payments.

Freelancer	Delivers services and completes projects: register/login, build a professional profile and portfolio, add skills/experience, browse jobs, submit proposals, accept interview invitations, communicate with clients, update progress, submit completed work.
Administrator	Manages and moderates the platform: manage users, approve or remove inappropriate content, monitor projects, view platform statistics, suspend users, manage job categories and skills.

4. Project Scope

4.1 In Scope

- Client and freelancer registration, authentication, and role-based access.
- Job posting, editing, closing, browsing, searching, and filtering.
- Proposal submission and review (accept/reject).
- Interview scheduling and response (accept/decline).
- Automated project workspace creation with milestone and progress tracking.
- Project delivery via GitHub links, with approval and revision workflows.
- Simulated payment initiation, release, and history logging.
- Event-driven notifications across all major platform actions.
- Administrator dashboard for user, job, and platform monitoring and moderation.

4.2 Out of Scope

- Integration with a real payment gateway or processing of real financial transactions.
- Video or audio interview functionality (only interview scheduling is supported).
- Support for multiple freelancers on a single project.
- Commercial deployment or production hosting beyond educational/portfolio use.

5. Functional Requirements

Functional requirements are grouped by system module. Each module lists the discrete capabilities the system must provide.

FR-1 Authentication & Authorization

The system shall provide secure account access and role-based control.

- User registration for clients and freelancers.
- Secure login using JSON Web Tokens (JWT).
- Password hashing for secure credential storage.
- Forgot-password / password-reset workflow.

- Role-based access control (Client, Freelancer, Administrator).

FR-2 User Profiles

The system shall allow users to build and maintain a professional profile.

- Capture of personal information.
- Listing of skills.
- Listing of experience.
- Portfolio upload and display.
- Profile picture upload.

FR-3 Job Marketplace

The system shall allow clients to publish jobs and freelancers to discover them.

- Clients can create, edit, delete, and close job postings.
- Freelancers can browse available jobs.
- Freelancers can search jobs by keyword.
- Freelancers can filter jobs by relevant criteria.

FR-4 Proposal Management

The system shall allow freelancers to submit, and clients to evaluate, job proposals.

- Freelancers submit proposals containin, estimated duration, cover letter, and portfolio attachments.
- Clients can view submitted proposals.
- Clients can accept a proposal.
- Clients can reject a proposal.

FR-5 Interview Scheduling

The system shall support scheduling and coordination of interviews between clients and freelancers.

- Clients can schedule interviews and select a date and time.
- Freelancers can accept an interview invitation.
- Freelancers can decline an interview invitation.
- The system sends notifications for upcoming interviews.

FR-6 Project Workspace

The system shall automatically create a dedicated workspace once a freelancer is hired.

- Workspace is created automatically after hiring.
- Workspace supports milestone definition and tracking.
- Workspace displays progress updates.

- Workspace stores GitHub repository links.
- Workspace displays current project status.
- Workspace supports revision requests.

FR-8 Project Delivery

The system shall support submission and review of completed work.

- Freelancers submit final work via GitHub links.
- Clients can approve submitted work.
- Clients can request revisions.

FR-9 Payment Simulation

The system shall simulate the financial transaction lifecycle without processing real payments.

- Simulated payment initiation.
- Payment release upon client approval of completed work.
- Payment history log per user.

FR-10 Notifications

The system shall notify users of relevant platform events.

- New proposal received.
- Interview invitation.
- Milestone update.
- Project completion.
- Payment release.

FR-11 Administrator Dashboard

The system shall provide administrators with platform oversight and moderation tools.

- View total registered users.
- View active projects.
- View completed projects.
- View platform activity logs.
- View system statistics.
- Manage (approve/remove) inappropriate content.
- Suspend user accounts when necessary.
- Manage job categories and skills taxonomy.

6. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement
Security	Passwords must be hashed; sessions authenticated via JWT; role-based authorization enforced on all protected API endpoints.
Usability	The interface shall follow modern, responsive UI/UX design suitable for desktop and mobile browsers.
Performance	Core marketplace actions (job search, proposal submission, messaging) should respond without perceptible delay under normal load.
Scalability	The architecture (MongoDB, Express.js, React.js, Node.js) shall support incremental growth in users, jobs, and projects.
Reliability	Real-time features (messaging, notifications) shall use a persistent connection (Socket.io) with graceful reconnection handling.
Maintainability	Codebase shall follow modular, production-ready MERN stack conventions to support future feature additions.
Auditability	Payment simulation and project actions shall be logged in a payment/activity history for review.

7. User Flows

7.1 Client Flow

1. Register / Login
2. Create profile
3. Post job
4. Receive proposals
5. Review applications
6. Schedule interviews
7. Hire freelancer
8. Project workspace created
9. Track progress & milestones
10. Approve final delivery
11. Release payment (simulation)
12. Leave review

7.2 Freelancer Flow

1. Register / Login
2. Complete profile & portfolio
3. Browse jobs

4. Submit proposal
5. Receive interview invitation
6. Attend interview
7. Get hired
8. Work on project
9. Submit progress
10. Deliver final work
11. Receive payment (simulation)
12. Receive review

7.3 Administrator Flow

1. Login
2. Dashboard
3. Manage users
4. Manage jobs
5. Monitor statistics
6. Resolve issues

8. Assumptions & Constraints

8.1 Assumptions

- Users have reliable internet access.
- Every user registers with a valid email address.
- Each project involves exactly one client and one freelancer.
- Payments are simulated; no real financial transactions occur.
- GitHub links are used as the mechanism for project submission.
- Users are expected to behave according to platform policies.

8.2 Constraints

- The system is developed using the MERN stack exclusively (MongoDB, Express.js, React.js, Node.js).
- Payment gateway integration is simulated due to development scope; no real payment processor is integrated.
- Video interviews are out of scope; only interview scheduling (date/time coordination) is supported.
- The system is intended for educational purposes and portfolio demonstration rather than commercial deployment.

9. Approval

This Business Requirements Document is subject to review and sign-off by the identified project stakeholders prior to the start of development.

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Project Sponsor			
Product Owner			
Technical Lead			